

The Self-Hate Massage

Assume a mindfulness posture, and breathe. *(Pause for 10 seconds)* Bring to mind an area of your life that chronically stirs up self-hate for you. Perhaps you have made some mistakes, or perhaps your limitations have prevented you from achieving something. You might dislike your physical body, or you might wish that you were someone else. Let's connect that hurt to our breathing and get acquainted with it using our new tools. *(Pause for 10 seconds)*

CONSIDER

Take a moment to collect yourself within your present space. Feel the air or the clothing on your skin. Notice any noises. *(Pause for 30 seconds)* Now consider this area of self-hate. Notice the discomfort you feel when you think of it. Even though you hate this thing, allow it to rest gently and without judgment inside your skin for one minute. Breathe. *(Pause for 1 minute)*

COMPASSION

As you breathe, experience yourself as a creature with limitations breathing in a material world. *(Pause)* You are not a god. *(Pause)* As you allow the breath to move in and out, imagine your area of self-hate moving in and out, as if you were using the breath to massage a place that is stuck or cramped. Help that area of self-hate circulate in and out with the breath. For one minute, give it and receive it with compassion. *(Pause for 1 minute)*

CLEANSE

Notice your entire body as it breathes. *(Pause)* Breathe with your mind, body, and soul opening the doors of the prison cells of your shame, hatreds, pain, and guilt. *(Pause)* Allow the clean air to sweep through those dark, stagnant places for one minute. *(Pause for 1 minute)*

And pause.